

Title: Wave management: Where do I start?

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

Okay, so I want to learn wave management. Where do I start?

For reference, in case it helps:

I primarily play Riven, in top lane. I'm in Iron at the moment (yes, we exist, and we're as bad as the legends say).

I want to learn wave management (and fundamentals in general) because I've been stuck in Iron ever since I started ranked back in late October, and I want to start to change that, and improve.

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 8]

Search for coaching videos, guides, and that kind of educational content.

AloisNL is one of the creators that comes to mind when it comes to toplane fundamentals.

Wave management can be fairly simple on the surface but its not easy to master, it has a lot of nuances. And to be honest, without knowledge of a lot of other stuff you wont get the best out of being able to set up a freeze or slowpush.

Wave Management is simply a tool that allows you to set up what you will do next, so if you aren't thinking multiple steps ahead then it will do you no good. And it starts from Lvl 1, you need to know

your matchup to know what you want or can do with the wave, and then play accordingly to manipulate that wave to your advantage.

[Comment 2 | Score: 3]

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j5hXC1m_lok&t=1387s

This was made before the map changes, but almost all of the concepts still translate.

Otherwise, go watch AloisNL's content. He's a Riven main as well, but he is all about the fundamentals and wave management.

[Comment 3 | Score: 3]

Not directly related to what you asked for, but even with garbage wave management, you can climb pretty high. If you're iron, it's likely that something even more fundamental is keeping you down (champion/camera control, csing, trading patterns).

[Comment 4 | Score: 3]

I can tell you how I learned it and you can decide if that is a way you could learn it as well or not. I think in order to learn something the fastest way you should always enjoy doing it/be interested in the steps that you are doing.

I watched a lot of videos from guides on the topic, obviously just the ones that I liked watching all the way through. I didn't really get a proper understanding of the things they said though, it didn't really make sense to me. So I went into practice tool to try to understand the minion mechanic and why they would suddenly start changing how they push. That made much more sense because I actually

was able to influence the things. But i was only able to do so because i already got an idea on what my goal was from the videos i watched.

Also, i didnt understand why it was so hard to keep up a freeze until i realized that minions have levels and stats too and if you are alone in the game your minions will lvl with you while the enemy minions stay at low lvl so the longer the game goes the stronger your minions get over enemy minions. That gave me an even better understanding how you can reliably create the lanestate you want, because i had to adapt how many minions i needed to keep a freeze etc.

It gave me a really good understanding of the theory of creating a lanestate, but to apply it in a real game is still something else. I first just tried to always freeze my lane so i can safely farm and decide when to engage. But that gave my enemy a lot of time to move into our jungle or mid and create an advantage for his team while they only lost a few waves. So i had to always think about what my enemy could do and when its actually good to push and when it isnt.

I started learning a lot of cheesy starts I can do to make the enemy do something with the wave that I wanted him to do, because I fell for thouse strats aswell. For example, pretending to recall right after you push a wave if you know you can kill your enemy, because if they think you based and push out the next wave with their abilities you can kill them with more ease. Sounds basic but you have to actually fall for it and think about it in order to do it.

I also slowly started to understand what tempo means, because lanestate has a lot to do with it. Its a term that is used everywhere but its something you cant just explain with a definition to make you understand it. Its something you learn by playing games and think about scenarios while playing, discussing it with friends or watching players who have a very specific playstyle that makes it more obvious, bausffs comes to mind. I didnt understand how he can win high elo games while dying so

much but he plays very well around tempo. He does it by muscle memory a lot of times aswell because he is already so used to it so it seems so naturally that you would think he is always lucky with his teammates.

So thats how I did it and still do it. I can recommend to watch some videos about it and try it in practice tool for sure, because to learn the theory isnt that time consuming. What will take time is to apply it in games and adapt it for your playstyle. The fun thing ablut it is that you can always learn something new if you are willing to put a lot of focus on it with every game because every game has a different scenario happening. As long as you are interested in it you will learn new ways.

I hope this helps :)

[Comment 5 | Score: 1]

[alois](<https://youtu.be/Gua-wZBzmzI?si=pBvIvAyEGRvY3xZv>) watch all his unranked to masters top guides, all of them and I would recomand rewatching the riven one at least 3 times. Click on the link in his video description for the guide page as well. absorb everything you hear from him as a spundge. If you watch and apply even half of what he says you will reach plat in 2 months.